

John o’Groats to Land’s End: Britain End to End [B2]

Percorrere la Gran Bretagna da nord a sud (o viceversa) è possibile. Ecco un suggestivo itinerario di oltre mille chilometri tra prati, brughiere, villaggi antichi e scogliere.

One fascinating way to experience the many different landscapes of the UK is to travel the whole length of the country from John o’Groats at the north-eastern [tip](#) of Scotland to Land’s End at the south-western [tip](#) of England. You can do the route by car, bike, or on foot. Some extreme athletes even run the whole way, averaging 80km a day for a little over two weeks.

DRAMATIC DIFFERENCE

John o’Groats is a small village on the north coast of Scotland, [facing towards](#) Norway across the North Sea. The weather is cold and windy, perfect for the [seals](#) and [puffins](#) that live around its rocky coast. Land’s End, meanwhile, is a point at the end of the south-west [tip](#) of England, on Cornwall’s [stunning](#) Lizard Peninsula. The weather here is much [milder](#), there are lots of wildflowers, and the [dramatic cliffs look over](#) the [English Channel](#) and the Celtic Sea. Although neither John o’Groats nor Land’s End is the absolute extreme point of Britain, both are fixed as such in tradition. John o’Groats to Land’s End

DISTANCE TRAVELLED

The distance between the two points is approximately 960km [as the crow flies](#). But by road it’s longer, around 1,400km, while to walk it [off-road](#) can be even further, some 1,900km, depending on the route chosen. The first recorded continuous walk was completed in 1871 by two brothers from Cheshire, who finished the route in just fifty-five days. Travellers choose their own paths by road, [trail](#) or cycleway. Some start in John o’Groats and head south to Land’s End (a journey known as JOGLE) while

others go in the other direction (LEJOG). Going south to north is perhaps slightly easier, as the wind is usually behind you and the sun isn't in your eyes.

LANDSCAPES

The route crosses an extraordinary [range](#) of landscapes. From John o'Groats, travellers journey through the [misty](#) Scottish Highlands. Once in Northern England, routes pass through the Lake District or the wet and windy Pennine Hills. [Further south](#), in the Midlands, walkers cross [gentler](#) farmland areas and the Peak District National Park, known for its [strange](#) rock formations. From there, the route takes [hikers](#) through the Cotswolds, with its [rolling hills](#), [meadows](#) and [cottages](#). The final [stretch](#) moves through Devon's [moorlands](#) and fossil [cliffs](#) before reaching the rocky [coves](#) of Cornwall. Those who complete the JOGLE or LEJOG on foot really have experienced the UK, step by step. Places

Ireland's Best Road Trip: The Wild Atlantic Way
Paesaggi impervi, selvaggi e rigogliosi: questo itinerario si snoda dalla pittoresca Kinsale, nel profondo sud irlandese, fino a Malin Head, il punto più settentrionale del Paese. Un viaggio tra borghi incantati e genti ospitali, temperate dai capricci del vento e dalle maree dell'oceano. Justin Ratcliffe

THE DUTCHMAN

The Scottish village of John o' Groats is named after a [Dutchman](#), Jan de Groot. In 1496, King James IV of Scotland gave de Groot permission to start a ferry service between the northernmost point of the Scottish [mainland](#) and the Orkney Islands. De Groot built himself an [eight-sided house](#) near the [harbour](#) on the [mainland](#) and lived there with his seven sons. The village that grew up around the house took Jan de Groot's name — but pronounced with a Scottish accent.

Glossary

- **tip** = estremità, punta
- **facing towards** = orientato verso, di fronte a
- **cliffs** = scogliere
- **look over** = affacciarsi su
- **off-road** = fuori strada
- **trail** = sentiero, percorso
- **cottages** = casette di campagna
- **coves** = calette, insenature
- **seals** = foche
- **dramatic** = spettacolari
- **Further south** = più a sud
- **gentler** = più dolci, meno ripide
- **Dutchman** = olandese
- **mainland** = terraferma
- **puffins** = pulcinelle di mare
- **milder** = più mite, più temperato
- **English Channel** = Canale della Manica
- **as the crow flies** = in linea d'aria
- **range** = varietà, gamma
- **misty** = nebbiose
- **hikers** = escursionisti
- **meadows** = prati
- **stunning** = mozzafiato
- **rolling hills** = dolci colline
- **stretch** = tratto
- **moorlands** = brughiere
- **eight-sided house** = casa ottagonale
- **harbour** = porto